PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender | Azure Active Directory / Entra ID | CISSP

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience strengthening enterprise security postures across complex, large-scale environments. I specialise in the Microsoft security stack, including Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), and I bring deep expertise in Single Sign-On (SSO) configuration, Conditional Access policy design and Privileged Access Management (PAM). I am experienced in threat hunting and vulnerability monitoring, security reporting and dashboards for senior stakeholders, and the maintenance of runbooks and incident response documentation. I am comfortable operating at a senior engineering level within professional services and enterprise environments, delivering security outcomes that balance operational resilience with regulatory compliance requirements.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Security Stack:** Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management), Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Purview
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Single Sign-On (SSO), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Public Key Infrastructure (PKI):** Certificate lifecycle management, PKI architecture and administration, secure authentication frameworks
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover, Falcon NG-SIEM
- **Threat Hunting and Vulnerability Management:** KQL-based analytics rule development, MITRE ATT&CK framework, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck
- **Security Automation and Reporting:** PowerShell scripting, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, Microsoft Sentinel Workbooks, senior stakeholder dashboards
- **Compliance and Governance:** ISO 27001, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials+, SC-200 equivalent knowledge
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, MCSA, CompTIA A+; SC-100 / SC-200 aligned knowledge base

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer – University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 – Present*

- Lead the deployment, configuration and day-to-day operation of Microsoft Sentinel as the organisation's primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, developing Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules and workbooks that provide meaningful security reporting to senior stakeholders.
- Oversee the Microsoft Defender suite across the enterprise, including Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender, ensuring effective configuration and integration with Sentinel for correlated threat detection.
- Architect and enforce Identity and Access Management (IAM) controls across Microsoft Entra ID, including Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Single Sign-On (SSO) integrations and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) to strengthen the organisation's Zero Trust security posture.
- Manage Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) and certificate lifecycle processes, ensuring secure authentication for enterprise services and maintaining certificate stores aligned to organisational security standards.
- Lead threat hunting operations using Microsoft Sentinel KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon, proactively identifying adversarial indicators mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, and feeding findings back into detection improvement cycles.
- Produce security dashboards, operational reports and board-level summaries that translate technical threat data into business-relevant risk insights for senior leadership.

- Maintain and continuously improve incident response runbooks and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, integrating BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) workflows to reduce manual effort and accelerate incident containment.
- Manage vulnerability management lifecycle using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io and AppCheck, ensuring timely remediation reporting aligned to risk appetite and compliance obligations.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity – University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Planned and delivered the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) rollout across an 8,000-user enterprise environment, integrating endpoint telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for unified threat monitoring and alerting.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policy design, SSO federation, MFA enforcement and automated account lifecycle workflows to minimise identity risk.
- Built and maintained KQL-based Sentinel analytics rules and detection workbooks covering phishing, credential abuse, lateral movement and data exfiltration scenarios, improving detection coverage across the threat landscape.
- Deployed and maintained CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) policies across the endpoint estate, tuning detections and investigating Falcon alerts as part of daily security operations.
- Developed and maintained security runbooks, response playbooks and escalation procedures, ensuring consistent and auditable responses to common incident types and contributing to the team's knowledge base.
- Coordinated vulnerability remediation programmes using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing remediation prioritisation reports and tracking closure of identified risks with system and application owners.
- Supported ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials+ compliance activities, producing evidence and assisting with internal audit cycles across the information security management controls framework.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure – HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Implemented endpoint security controls, network segmentation policies and cloud access security measures across Microsoft Azure-hosted SaaS infrastructure, reducing the organisation's attack surface.
- Administered Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), enforcing device compliance baselines and conditional access policies across a distributed workforce.
- Managed Azure Active Directory (now Entra ID) identity lifecycle including onboarding, offboarding automation, role-based access control (RBAC) and audit log review processes.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance and internal audit activities, producing evidence packs covering information security controls and supporting remediation of identified gaps.
- Maintained patch compliance and endpoint security tooling across the infrastructure estate, coordinating with vendors and internal teams to resolve security platform incidents promptly.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led end-to-end deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user UAL environment, integrating with Microsoft Sentinel to deliver a unified SIEM and extended detection and response (XDR) capability.
- Designed and implemented Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access architecture covering over 8,000 user accounts, enforcing Zero Trust access controls, MFA and SSO that materially reduced identity-related risk.
- Built a comprehensive library of Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, improving proactive threat detection coverage across the enterprise.
- Developed automated Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks integrating BeyondTrust PAM with Sentinel Logic Apps, eliminating manual steps from high-frequency incident workflows.
- Achieved and maintained Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification, demonstrating senior-level competence across security engineering, IAM, cryptography and risk management domains.
- Produced executive security dashboards and operational reporting that supported informed risk decision-making at board and senior management level.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+

- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)